NSRA Title XVII · Sec. 905 · Sec. 1710

# America Can Build Again: Permits on a Clock, Costs in Public, Power from Dams We Already Have

The American Society of Civil Engineers grades U.S. infrastructure a **C**, with a $3.7 trillion ten-year funding gap. The country built about 888 miles of new high-voltage transmission in 2024, a fraction of what the grid needs. Title XVII applies lessons from Japan and China to build faster and cheaper, while keeping every substantive environmental, safety, labor, and tribal-consultation protection.

## What it does

| Provision | Draft text |
|---|---|
| **Power existing dams** | Only a small share of America's roughly 90,000 dams generate electricity. A revolving fund adds generation at non-powered dams and modernizes old hydropower, with dam safety fixed first (Sec. 1703) |
| **Licenses on a schedule** | FERC publishes one schedule for every federal decision on a hydropower license; total extensions capped at one year (Sec. 1704) |
| **Inspect everything every 5 years** | A Japan-style hands-on inspection of bridges, dams, and other covered assets at least every five years, with a public registry and required repairs (Sec. 1705) |
| **Publish what it costs** | Standard unit costs (per lane-mile, per kilometer of track, per megawatt) reported and benchmarked; projects far above the median must explain why; a public library of pre-approved standard designs (Sec. 1706) |
| **Permits on a clock** | One federal schedule per project on the Permitting Dashboard, limits on deadline extensions, and a 150-day window for lawsuits (Sec. 1707) |
| **Grid backbone** | A national high-voltage transmission backbone plan and 15% of grid funds for long-duration storage, including pumped hydro (Sec. 905) |
| **Protect before disaster** | Pre-disaster mitigation for wildfire, flood, and extreme heat restored and protected from administrative cancellation, with a rural set-aside (Sec. 1710) |

## Faster, not looser

Every section keeps substantive law intact: the Clean Water Act, Endangered Species Act, Federal Power Act conditions, State water-quality authority, labor standards, and tribal consultation. What changes is the clock and the transparency. Projects are funded inside existing allocations, with no new authorization fight.

*Operative text: Title XVII (Secs. 1701–1710) and Sec. 905.*